Where You Are: Finding the Gaps in Dad's Care, and the Steps That Follow

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, what this one produces, and who is involved next.

Looking into Dad's care can feel like a job with no edges. One question leads to three more, and none of them seems to finish.

It has edges. It is one topic in step three of nine, and it has a clear finish. Below are all nine steps, with yours marked, and a note on who is involved after it.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

You are here. This is step three, and you're on its first topic. For a family with care already in place, that means comparing what Dad needs with the help that actually reaches him. You finish the topic with a written list of gaps and open questions. Each line says where the information came from, who is following up, where it stands, and the next action or the professional it goes to.

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this step produces

A list, in plain words, of where Dad's plan and Dad's week differ and of what nobody has confirmed yet. The family's part is done when every line has a source, a name and a status. It is the family's own list, put in order. It doesn't say that any service has fallen short, and it doesn't assess Dad.

The names matter as much as the lines. The Family Caregiver Alliance suggests that a family meeting end with a written summary of what each person has agreed to. The name beside each open line on your list does the same job. [1]

What happens next

Two more topics finish the Define Needs step. The first sets out what any care arrangement has to be able to do for Dad. The second puts the family's next actions in order. Your list of gaps is where both begin. After Define Needs comes Explore Options.

The list will need another look later. The National Institute on Aging says of shared caregiving arrangements that over time they may need to be revised, because the needs of the person receiving care and family members' availability can change. Expect to come back to it. [2]

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: comparing, asking, writing down, and putting a name beside each open line.
- Dad: his own account of the help he gets and of what he'd like to be different. His preferences stay his, separate from the family's wishes.
- Your sister, or whoever fills in: what she covers that isn't on any schedule, and how she says she's managing.
- The agency and his clinicians (doctor, nurse, pharmacist): answers about the help that was scheduled, and every clinical question.
- A care professional: where a family works with your care consultant, the family's account is read alongside your care consultant's own observations, to identify unmet needs and the differences between the support Dad needs and the support he has. That reading takes in the family's capacity and Dad's quality of life as well as clinical concerns.

What this page doesn't promise

How long this step takes, who will be available, or what your list will turn up. The nine steps give an order. They don't give dates.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, what it produces and who comes in next. The care interview is how the comparing gets done against a full picture: it asks about each area of Dad's daily life and who covers it, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The suggestion to write down what each person has agreed to comes from the Family Caregiver Alliance, and the remark that caregiving arrangements get revised over time comes from the National Institute on Aging.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Holding a Family Meeting
2. National Institute on Aging, Sharing Caregiving Responsibilities